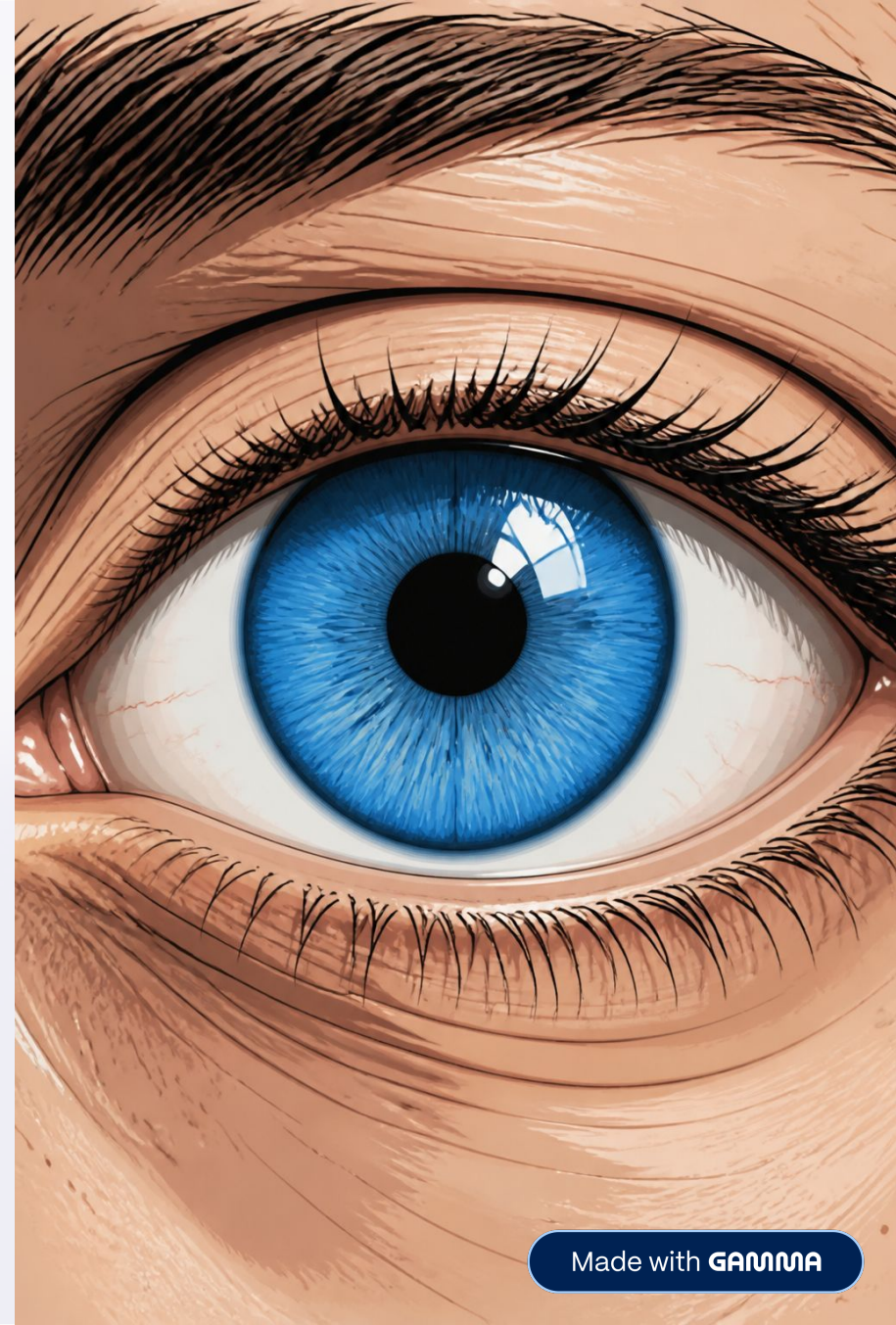
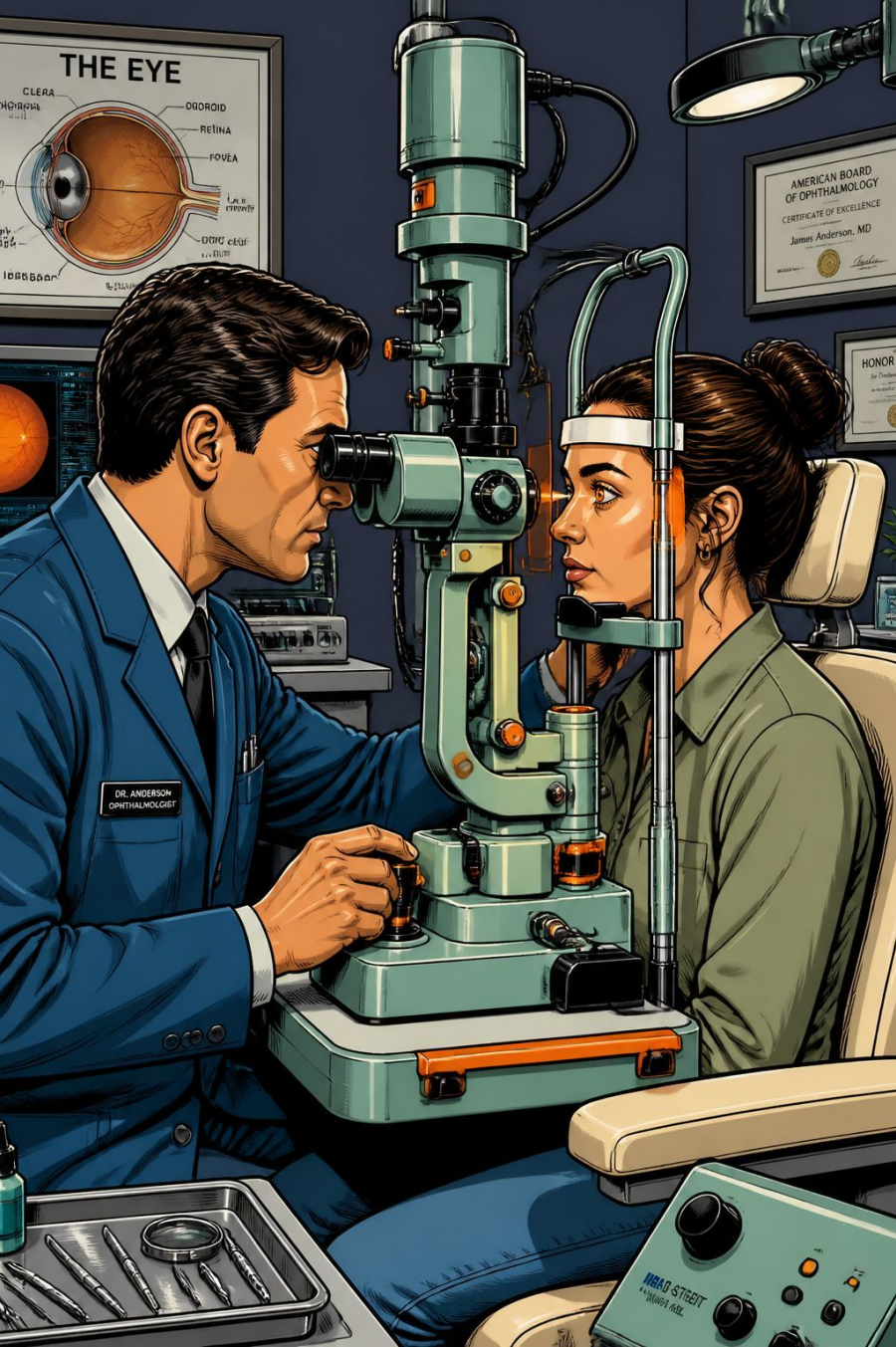


How Often Should You Have an Eye Examination?

Your eyes may feel perfectly healthy — but that doesn't always mean they are. Many eye conditions develop gradually, without noticeable symptoms.





More Than Just a Glasses Check

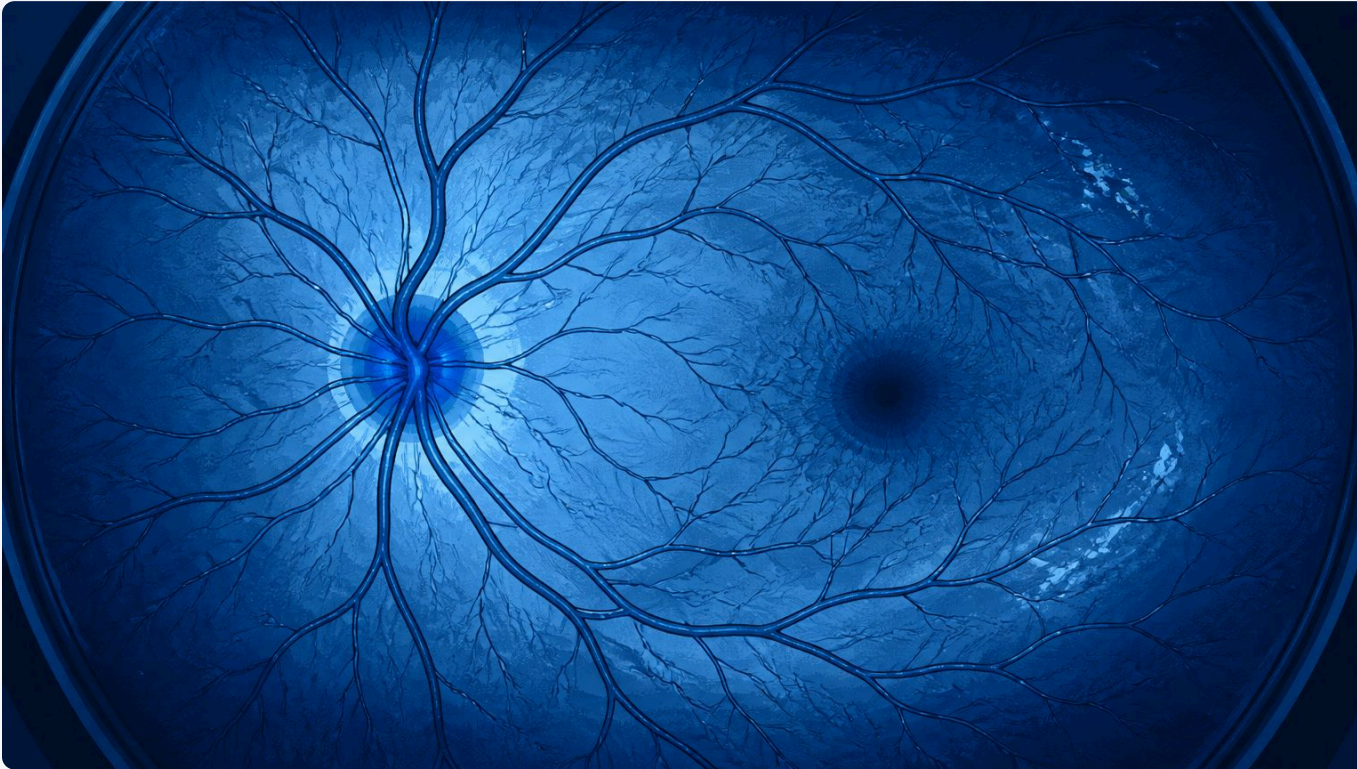
A comprehensive eye exam assesses your vision and looks for signs of conditions affecting your eyes *and* overall health. Depending on your age and risk factors, it may include:

Visual Acuity

Eye Pressure

Peripheral Vision

Optic Nerve & Retina



WHY IT MATTERS

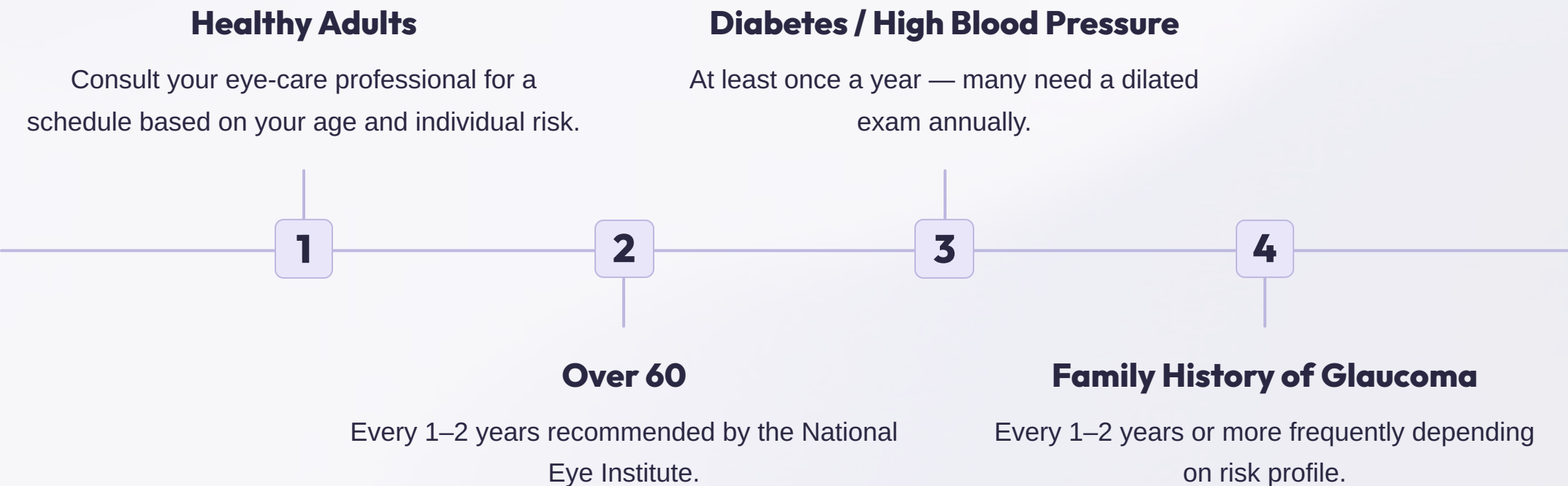
Early Detection Saves Sight

Some conditions — including **glaucoma** — can cause damage *before* you notice any change in vision. A comprehensive dilated eye exam can detect these problems early, when treatment may be more effective.

- ❑ By the time noticeable vision loss occurs, damage may already have happened.

Recommended Exam Frequency

There's no single schedule for everyone. Frequency depends on your age, health, family history, and existing eye conditions.





People Over 60

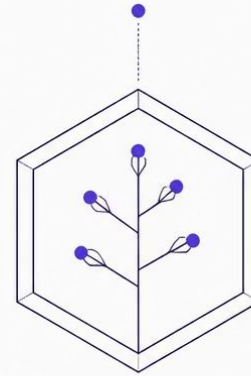
The risk of several eye conditions increases with age. The **National Eye Institute** recommends that people over 60 discuss regular dilated eye examinations with their eye-care professional. For many in this age group, examinations every **1–2 years** may be appropriate depending on individual risk.

HIGH-RISK GROUPS

Diabetes & High Blood Pressure

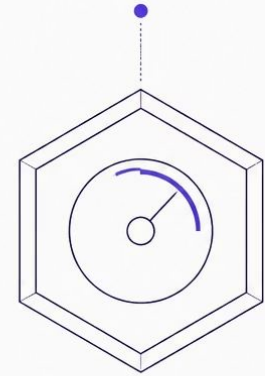
Both conditions can significantly increase the risk of eye problems. The National Eye Institute notes that many people with diabetes or high blood pressure need a **dilated eye examination at least once a year**.

Your doctor or eye-care professional can recommend the schedule appropriate for you.



Diabetes

(can damage blood vessels in the retina, leading to diabetic retinopathy)



High Blood Pressure

(can affect blood flow to the eyes, causing hypertensive retinopathy)

Family History of Glaucoma

If glaucoma runs in your family, you may have a **higher risk** of developing the disease. Higher-risk individuals may need comprehensive eye examinations **every 1–2 years** — or more frequently depending on their risk profile.



Don't Wait Until Vision Blurs



One of the biggest mistakes people make is assuming they only need an eye exam when their vision becomes blurry.

Silent Progression

Many eye diseases have few or no symptoms in early stages.

Preventable Damage

Regular exams let your eye-care professional catch problems *before* they significantly affect your vision.

When to Seek Immediate Care

Don't wait for your next routine appointment if you experience sudden or significant changes. Seek prompt medical attention for:

- **Sudden loss of vision**
- **Sudden or severe eye pain**
- **New flashes of light or sudden increase in floaters**
- **Significant redness with pain or blurred vision**
- **Sudden changes in peripheral vision**



Make Your Eye Health a Priority

Your eyes deserve the same attention you give to the rest of your health. Regular eye examinations can help detect vision problems and eye diseases early — protecting your sight for the future.

Don't wait until you have difficulty seeing before you check your eyes. Book a comprehensive eye examination with [Akafo Eye Services](#) today.

This article is for general educational purposes and does not replace professional medical advice. The appropriate frequency of eye examinations varies from person to person.